🚀 A Day in the Life of a DevOps Engineer

Interviewer: Can you explain your day-to-day activities as a DevOps Engineer?
You:
"Usually, my day starts with checking my Outlook emails, Microsoft Teams messages, and Jira tickets. I check if there are any urgent requests or new tasks, and I continue working on any pending tickets from the previous day. After that, we normally have a daily stand-up meeting where I explain what I worked on yesterday, what I am working on today, and if I have any blockers.
During the day, one of my regular activities is monitoring the infrastructure and applications using tools like Prometheus and Grafana. I check the dashboards for any abnormal behavior, resource issues, or application problems. If I find an issue, I investigate it, check the logs and infrastructure, and either fix it myself or discuss it with a senior team member if required.
I also work on CI/CD pipelines. We usually maintain and modify existing pipelines based on project requirements rather than creating new pipelines every day. For example, if we need to add a Trivy security scanning stage for Docker images, I update the pipeline, test the changes in a lower environment, and after the required approval, the change is moved to production.
Based on project requirements, I also work with Ansible and Terraform. With Ansible, I manage server configuration changes such as installing packages or updating configurations. With Terraform, I provision or modify AWS infrastructure when we receive a requirement. We normally test these changes in lower environments first and then follow the approval process before making production changes.
Another important part of my work is incident handling and troubleshooting. If a client or internal team raises an issue through Jira, I understand the problem, check monitoring dashboards, logs, deployments, and infrastructure, and try to find the root cause. If I need more information, I communicate with the client or team through Microsoft Teams or a call, work on the fix, and update the Jira ticket with the progress and resolution.
I also take care of documentation whenever we implement something new, create a POC, or make an important configuration change. We use tools like Confluence or SharePoint so that the team can refer to the implementation later. If I have free time, I use it for self-learning, training, or learning tools like Kubernetes, Terraform, cloud, CI/CD, security, and monitoring.
At the end of the day, I update my Jira tickets and timesheet, add the required comments, and keep track of any pending work for the next day. Overall, my main responsibilities are monitoring, CI/CD, troubleshooting, automation, infrastructure changes, documentation, and supporting the team. I also try to complete my work within my shift hours and maintain a good work-life balance."

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🕗 1. Morning — Login and Check Emails

I usually login and first check my **Outlook emails**.
If there is any urgent email, I check and respond to it. Otherwise, I go through the missed emails and see if there is anything related to my work.
After that, I check **Microsoft Teams** for any missed messages or updates from my team.

🎫 2. Check Jira Tickets

Next, I check **Jira**.
Jira is used in companies to create and track work tickets. Whether it is a DevOps team or development team, most of the work is normally tracked through tickets.
A ticket contains the task description and the work that needs to be done.
If I have a ticket assigned to me, I take that ticket and start working on it. If required, I assign the ticket to myself so my manager and team members know that I am working on it.
I also check if there are any **new tickets** assigned to me.
Some tickets may take more than one day, so I first continue working on my **pending tickets** and then check if there are any new tasks.
So, my basic morning routine is:
Outlook → Teams → Jira → Pending/New Tickets

👥 3. Daily Stand-up Meeting

After that, we normally have a **daily stand-up meeting**, sometimes called **DSTM – Daily Standup Meeting**.
All team members give an update about their work.
Normally, I explain:

- What I worked on yesterday
- What I am working on today
- If I have any blockers or need help

Usually, the meeting takes around **15–20 minutes**.
If I am facing any issue and need help, I mention it in the meeting so the manager can assign another team member to help me.

📊 **4. Infrastructure Monitoring**
In a DevOps project, we may have multiple applications deployed in different infrastructure environments.
So, monitoring is an important part of my daily work.
I use **Grafana** dashboards to check the infrastructure and application health.
I check whether there are any issues with resources, applications, or services.
If I find an issue, I first try to investigate and fix it myself. If the issue is complex or I need help, I discuss it with a senior team member.

🔄 **5. CI/CD Pipeline Work**
CI/CD pipelines are also an important part of DevOps work.
We don't normally create a completely new pipeline every day. Most of the time, we **maintain or modify existing pipelines** based on new requirements.
For example, if the team wants to add a **Trivy security scanning stage** to scan Docker images for vulnerabilities, I modify the existing pipeline and add that stage.
Normally, we don't directly make such changes in production.
The process is:
Pipeline Change → Lower Environment → Testing → Approval → Production
First, I make the change in a lower environment and test it properly.
After successful testing, we take the required approval and then deploy the change to production.

⚙️ **6. Configuration Management — Ansible**
Configuration management is another task that comes based on project requirements.
We use **Ansible** to update or manage server configurations.
For example, a manager or client may ask us to install a package, update a configuration, or make some changes on servers.
I make the required changes using Ansible.
Again, we normally test the changes in a **lower environment first**.
After testing and getting the required approval, we apply the changes in production.

🏗️ **7. Infrastructure as Code — Terraform**
Terraform work is also part of DevOps, but it may not happen every single day.
Sometimes we receive a request to provision new infrastructure or modify existing infrastructure.
For example, a client may request a new server or some AWS resources with specific software or configuration.
In that situation, I update the **Terraform code** according to the requirement.
Then Terraform is used to provision the required resources.
After the required testing and process, the infrastructure can be shared with the client or used by the project/engagement.

📈 **8. Monitoring and Logging**
Monitoring and logging are also regular DevOps activities.
I commonly use **Prometheus and Grafana** for monitoring and dashboards.
Prometheus collects metrics and Grafana helps us visualize those metrics through dashboards.
I regularly check the dashboards and analyze the available information.
If I see something abnormal, I investigate the issue and try to find the root cause.
Based on the issue, I take the required action and fix it or involve the appropriate team.

🚨 **9. Incident Response and Troubleshooting**
Another important part of DevOps work is **incident handling and troubleshooting**.
Usually, clients or internal teams raise an issue through a **Jira ticket**.
For example, there could be an application issue, server issue, deployment failure, high resource usage, or some other production problem.
I take the ticket, understand the issue, investigate it, and try to find the root cause.
I check monitoring dashboards, logs, infrastructure, deployments, or other relevant areas depending on the issue.
If I need more information, I communicate with the client through **Microsoft Teams or a call** and understand the problem clearly.
After finding the issue, I work on the fix and update the Jira ticket with the progress and resolution.

📝 **10. Documentation**
Documentation is also important, especially when working on large projects.
Whenever we implement something new, create a POC, or make an important configuration or process change, we document it.
We may use tools such as **Confluence or SharePoint**.
The main purpose is that other team members can understand what was implemented and how it works later.
It also helps when someone new joins the project or when we need to refer to an old implementation.

📚 **11. Self-Learning**
If I have some free time and there are no urgent tasks, I use that time for **self-learning**.
As a DevOps engineer, there are many tools and technologies to learn.
I can learn new DevOps tools, attend company training sessions, or explore concepts that may be useful for my current project.

For example, I can spend some time learning Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD, cloud services, security tools, or monitoring tools.

⏱️ **12. Timesheet**
We also maintain a **daily timesheet**.
The timesheet is used to record the work we performed during the day and how much time was spent on different activities.
Normally, around **nine hours** may be logged depending on the company's working hours.
The time can be divided between Jira tickets, troubleshooting, meetings, deployments, documentation, self-learning, and other project activities.

🏁 **13. End of the Day**
At the end of the day, I make sure my assigned work and Jira updates are properly updated.
If I worked on a ticket, I update the status and add the required comments.
If there is any pending work, I keep track of it so I can continue it on the next working day.

⚖️ **14. Work-Life Balance**
One important thing is to work properly within the assigned shift hours.
DevOps can sometimes involve production issues or incidents, so there may be situations where we need to work beyond normal hours.
But unnecessary overtime should be avoided when it is not required.
Maintaining a proper work-life balance helps avoid unnecessary stress, irritation, and burnout.